

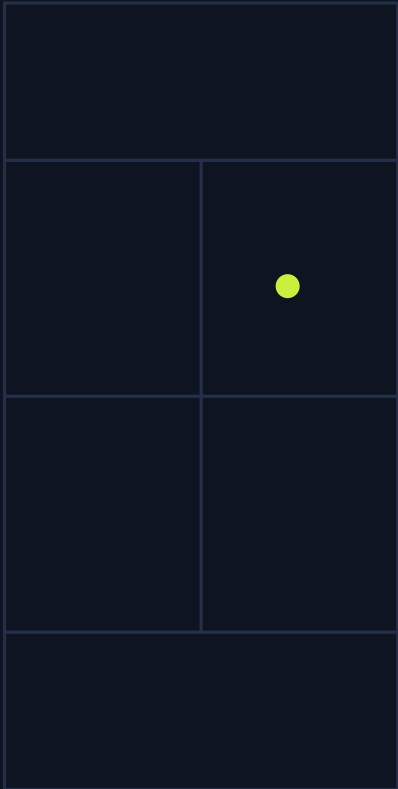
LAYL

(Arabic: “night”)

Padel after dark. Built for 45°C.

A niche padel clothing line designed for how Dubai actually plays: at night, in the heat, in pairs, and straight to dinner.

Ideas, the pick, product, pricing, launch plan and numbers.



One page, if you read nothing else

Padel is the fastest-growing social sport in Dubai, and almost everyone plays it in clothes designed for a Spanish afternoon. The big padel brands (Bullpadel, Nox, Head, Adidas, Babolat) sell generic European kit. Nobody is designing for the three things that define padel here: **brutal heat, night play, and padel as a social scene.**

The gap

Heat-rated, night-ready, modest-friendly padel wear made *for the Gulf*. Existing brands treat the Middle East as an export market, not a design brief.

The concept: LAYL

A premium padel label built around night courts. Cooling fabric, floodlight-reflective details, dark palette that hides sweat, and pieces that go from court to dinner.

The hook nobody has

Partner Sets. Padel is always doubles, and every player is either a *Drive* (right) or *Revés* (left) side player. Sell matched pairs, side-coded. It is shareable, giftable, and doubles the basket.

How it makes money

Direct-to-consumer at AED 180–420 per piece (~70% gross margin), club pro-shop wholesale, and a B2B arm making custom kits for clubs, academies and corporate leagues.

Recommendation: Launch LAYL with 12 pieces and Partner Sets as the hero, sell through Instagram + your own site + 3–5 club pro shops, and run Club Kit Studio (B2B) in parallel for cash flow. Lean launch budget roughly **AED 110k**; full launch roughly **AED 250k**. Base-case year one: ~6,000 units, ~**AED 1.15M revenue**.

The market is built for this

What makes Dubai different from every other padel market, and why it matters for clothing:

Dubai reality	What it means for the clothes
Summer courts sit at 38–45°C with high humidity; most play moves to evenings and nights.	Cooling and fast-dry are not features, they are the product. Night play means floodlights, so reflective detail and dark colours make sense in a way they don't in Madrid.
Padel is a social currency: after-work games, corporate leagues, weekend brunch before or after.	People want to look good on court and walk straight into dinner. Court-to-table cuts beat pure sportswear.
Affluent, image-conscious buyers used to paying for premium (tennis and golf set the bar).	Price at premium-accessible AED 180–420. Cheap would hurt the brand here.
Big female and Emirati/GCC participation, and a real demand for modest performance wear.	A modest capsule (long sleeves, full-length leggings under skorts, longer cuts) is an under-served niche, and a genuine reason to choose LAYL over Adidas.
Every club has a pro shop, an academy, and leagues; corporates run team tournaments.	Built-in wholesale and B2B custom-kit channels from day one.
Ramadan turns night sport into a season of its own (late-night tournaments after iftar).	A yearly Ramadan night capsule becomes the brand's signature drop.
Instagram, TikTok and Tabby/Tamara (buy-now-pay-later) drive fashion buying.	DTC online-first launch is realistic; BNPL lifts basket size on sets.

Court counts and player numbers in the UAE have grown fast since 2020 but published figures vary widely; treat any headline number as directional and sanity-check by visiting clubs and asking pro shops what sells.

Who is already there

Player	What they do well	Where they leave a gap
Padel specialists (Bullpadel, Nox, Siux, Head)	Credibility, rackets, pro endorsements	Apparel is secondary, loud, Spanish-market design
Big sportswear (Adidas, Nike, Lacoste)	Distribution, tech fabrics	Not padel-specific, nothing Gulf-specific
Premium athleisure (Lululemon, Alo, Varley)	Look, fit, lifestyle	No padel identity, no heat/night angle
Club-branded merch	Loyalty	Generic blanks, low quality

Eleven directions, from safest to wildest

Everything I'd consider. Some are brands on their own, most work better as pieces of one brand. Scores are my judgement for Dubai (1 = weak, 5 = strong).

#	Idea	What it is	Money	Niche
1	LAYL — Night Court	Padel wear designed for floodlit night play: dark palette, reflective piping, glow-accent logos, cooling fabric.	5	5
2	45° Heat Index	Every garment carries a heat rating (e.g. "rated to 45°C"). Cooling yarns, laser-cut vents, UPF 50+.	4	4
3	Partner Sets	Matched doubles kits, side-coded DRIVE / REVÉS, optional name print. Sold as pairs.	5	5
4	Modest Performance	Women's padel line: long sleeves, skort-and-legging systems, longer tunics, hijab-compatible cooling caps.	4	5
5	Court-to-Table	Elevated polos, knit shorts and overshirts that look like resort wear but play like sportswear.	4	3
6	Desert Heritage	Sadu-weave patterns, dune palette, Arabic typography. Emirati pride without cliché.	3	4
7	Club Kit Studio (B2B)	Custom kits for clubs, academies, corporate leagues, tournaments. Low MOQ, fast turnaround.	5	3
8	Ramadan Night Capsule	Yearly limited drop for late-night Ramadan tournaments. Collectible, hype-driven.	4	5
9	Mini Padel (Kids)	Academy kits and parent-child matching sets. Academies are full of expat kids.	3	3
10	Court Locker	Vending/kiosk at clubs: socks, caps, cooling towels, spare shirts. People forget kit or sweat through it.	3	4
11	Recovery & Après	Post-match cooling towels, slides, oversized tees, ice-vest. Low size risk, high margin.	3	3

A few extra product hooks worth stealing, whichever direction you pick

- **Sweat-proof colourways.** Grey and light blue show sweat instantly in Dubai. Deep navy, black, sand-melange and patterned fabrics don't. Market it.
- **Ball pocket that doesn't bounce.** Every padel player stuffs a ball in their skort or shorts. Design a proper one.
- **Sand-proof socks.** Padel turf is sand-filled; grit gets in shoes. A sock with a tight cuff and cushioned sole is a small, repeat-purchase winner.
- **Glass-wall graphics.** Padel is played inside glass walls. A logo or print that reads well through glass on streamed matches is a subtle detail players notice.
- **Shot-name graphics.** Bandeja, Víbora, Chiquita, Por Tres. Insider language builds community.

LAYL: padel after dark

Don't launch eleven ideas. Launch one brand with a sharp story, and use the other ideas as features, drops and revenue lines inside it.

Layer	Ideas used	Role
Brand story	#1 Night Court + #2 Heat Index	Why LAYL exists: Dubai plays at night, in the heat.
Hero product	#3 Partner Sets	The thing people talk about, post and gift.
Built in from launch	#4 Modest capsule, sweat-proof colours, ball pocket	Real reasons to switch from Adidas.
Cash engine	#7 Club Kit Studio	B2B orders pay the bills while the brand builds.
Year-one drops	#8 Ramadan capsule, #6 Heritage collab, #11 Après	Keep Instagram and repeat buyers busy.
Later	#9 Kids, #10 Court Locker	Once the brand has pull with clubs.

Why this combination wins

- **It's true.** The night-and-heat story comes from how people actually play here, so it doesn't need to be explained.
- **It's hard for the giants to copy.** Adidas won't build a Dubai-specific padel range; a local brand can own that position.
- **Partner Sets double the order value.** One buyer, two outfits. Corporate teams and couples are natural buyers.
- **It has a B2B floor.** Club and corporate kits bring predictable orders even if DTC is slow at first.
- **It travels.** Riyadh, Doha, Kuwait and Bahrain have the same heat, the same night play and fast-growing padel scenes.

Name options (check trademark availability before committing)

Name	Meaning / feel	Verdict
LAYL	Arabic for night. Short, premium, bilingual.	First choice
SHAMAL	The hot desert wind. Strong, heat-led.	Strong alternative
QAMAR	Moon. Softer, good for a women's line.	Sub-line name
BANDEJA	The signature padel overhead shot. Insider-y.	Good for a graphic tee range
Por Tres Club	The shot that goes over the wall. Playful.	Too niche for main brand

How LAYL looks and sounds

Palette

Midnight navy and black (hide sweat, look sharp under lights), sand and dune neutrals (Dubai daylight), one electric floodlight lime for accents and reflective hits.

Tone

Confident, understated, a bit nocturnal. Less 'extreme sports', more members' club. Bilingual English/Arabic on key pieces.

Photography

Shot at night on real Dubai courts under floodlights, skyline behind the glass. Never a white studio.

Taglines

"Padel after dark." · "Built for 45°C." · "Play late. Stay cool." · "Two sides. One team." (Partner Sets)

Signature details

Crescent-moon logo mark, reflective lime piping on the back yoke, heat rating printed on the inside neck ("Rated 45°"), DRIVE / REVÉS side codes on Partner Sets.

Community

LAYL Night Sessions: monthly late-night open games, DJ, cold towels, kit try-on. The event is the marketing.

Who we're selling to

Customer	Who they are	What they buy
The After-Work Four	Expat professionals, 28–45, weekly games with the same group.	Partner Sets, polos, shorts, socks
The Club Regular	Plays 3–5 times a week, leagues, knows the brands.	Performance pieces, multiple colours, repeat socks
Modest-Performance Women	Emirati, GCC and Muslim expat women; also anyone wanting more coverage in the sun.	Modest capsule, cooling caps, layering sets
Corporates & Clubs	HR teams, club managers, academy owners, tournament organisers.	Custom team kits (B2B)
Gifters	Partners, friends, corporate gifting, Eid and Ramadan.	Partner Sets, gift boxes

The launch collection: 12 pieces

Keep it tight. Two to three colours each, fewer sizes on the riskier items. Costs are indicative landed costs (made, shipped, duty) at 150–300 units per style.

Piece	Key features	Landed cost (AED)	Retail (AED)	Margin
Night Court Tee (M/W)	Cooling knit, laser vents, reflective back yoke, heat rating label	45	220	80%
Floodlight Polo (M)	Court-to-table polo, sweat-proof navy/black, stretch	60	280	79%
Partner Set (pair)	2 tees, side-coded DRIVE / REVÉS, optional name print	100	480	79%
Rally Shorts (M)	4-way stretch, ball pocket, zip phone pocket	50	240	79%
Bandeja Skort (W)	Built-in shorts, proper ball pocket, UPF 50+	55	260	79%
Modest Long-Sleeve (W)	Longer cut, thumbholes, cooling mesh underarm	60	280	79%
Full-Length Legging (W)	Pairs under skort, cooling, squat-proof	55	260	79%
Cooling Cap / Visor	Evaporative band, reflective logo	22	140	84%
Modest Cooling Head Cover	Breathable performance fabric, sits under a cap	20	120	83%
Sand-Proof Sock (3-pack)	Tight cuff, cushioned sole, odour control	18	95	81%
After-Dark Overshirt	Light layer for AC dinners after the game	80	380	79%
Cooling Towel	Chill-on-wet towel, gift/add-on item	10	70	86%

Margins shown are before VAT, discounts and channel fees. Wholesale to pro shops is typically around 50% of retail, which still leaves ~50–60% gross margin.

Sourcing

Where	Good for	Watch out for
Turkey (Istanbul, Izmir, Bursa)	Sportswear quality, low MOQs, 2–4 week lead times, close to Dubai	Cost higher than Asia
Portugal (Porto region)	Premium finish, strong story, small runs	Most expensive, longer shipping
Pakistan (Sialkot, Lahore)	Sportswear specialists, good value, big team-kit capacity — great for B2B	Needs close QC
China (Guangdong, Fujian)	Technical cooling fabrics, reflective trims, socks, towels	Higher MOQs, IP care

Practical route: main garments from Turkey, B2B team kits from Pakistan, fabrics/accessories from China. Order samples from 3 factories per category and wear-test them on real night courts in August.

How LAYL gets onto courts

Channel	How	Why it works here
Instagram & TikTok	Night-court content, doubles duos, coach tips, 'sweat test' videos	Where Dubai discovers brands
Own website	Shopify + Tabby/Tamara, same-day Dubai delivery	Full margin, own the customer data
Club pro shops	3–5 clubs at launch, consignment or wholesale, try-on rails	Players buy where they play
Coach ambassadors	10–15 coaches in kit, 10% code, free Partner Sets	Coaches are the trust layer in padel
LAYL Night Sessions	Monthly late-night games + pop-up shop	Turns customers into community
Corporate leagues	Sponsor kits for 2–3 company tournaments, sell custom kits after	Opens the B2B pipeline
Marketplaces (later)	Noon, Amazon.ae, Namshi once reviews exist	Reach, but lower margin

Launch calendar

Dubai's padel year runs opposite to Europe. Summer is brutal but players still play at night, indoors or in air-conditioned courts; October to April is peak season.

When	Move
Oct–Nov	Soft launch with Partner Sets. First Night Session. Seed ambassadors.
Dec–Jan	Gifting season (Christmas, New Year, corporate gifts). Club pro-shop rollout.
Feb–Mar	Ramadan Night Capsule + late-night Ramadan tournament. Biggest brand moment.
Apr	Eid gifting; first B2B corporate league season.
May–Sep	'Built for 45°C' summer campaign. The heat is the proof. Restock bestsellers.

Ramadan dates shift about 11 days earlier each year; plan the capsule around the actual dates.

What it costs and what it could make

Launch budget

Item	Lean (AED)	Full (AED)	Notes
Trade licence & setup	15,000	25,000	Free-zone e-commerce licence; mainland if you want a physical shop
Design, tech packs, samples	12,000	30,000	Freelance designer + 2–3 sample rounds
First production	45,000	95,000	~800 vs ~1,600 units at ~AED 55–60 landed
Brand identity & website	8,000	25,000	Logo, packaging, Shopify build
Photo & video content	8,000	25,000	Night shoots on real courts
Launch event & ambassadors	10,000	25,000	First Night Session, seeded kits
Paid social (first 3 months)	7,000	15,000	Meta/TikTok tests
Trademark (UAE)	5,000	10,000	Add GCC countries in the full version
Contingency	—	—	Keep ~10% aside; not included in the totals
Total	~110,000	~250,000	

Year-one scenarios (illustrative)

Assumes 60% of units sold direct at an average ~AED 240 and 40% wholesale/B2B at ~AED 120, giving a blended ~AED 192 per unit; landed cost ~AED 62 per unit.

	Conservative	Base	Upside
Units sold	2,500	6,000	12,000
Revenue	480,000	1,152,000	2,304,000
Cost of goods	155,000	372,000	744,000
Gross profit	325,000	780,000	1,560,000
Marketing, events, ambassadors	120,000	250,000	450,000
Fulfilment, fees, returns	60,000	130,000	250,000
Licence, admin, staff	120,000	170,000	250,000
Operating profit	25,000	230,000	610,000

All figures in AED, excluding VAT. These are planning numbers, not forecasts: the real test is sell-through of the first production run. Base case means ~500 units a month, which is about 15–20 sales a day across all channels.

The lever that matters most: Partner Sets and B2B. One corporate league with 16 teams of 4 players is 64 kits in one invoice. At ~AED 150 a kit, ten of those a year is ~AED 100k of revenue with almost no marketing cost.

What can go wrong, and how to handle it

Setting up in Dubai (confirm current rules with a business setup adviser)

- **Licence:** a free-zone e-commerce/trading licence is the cheapest start. You need a mainland licence (or a partner shop) to sell from a physical store.
- **Trademark:** file the name and logo with the UAE Ministry of Economy before you print anything; add Saudi Arabia and other GCC countries if you plan to expand.
- **VAT:** registration becomes mandatory above AED 375k taxable turnover a year, so the base case will need it.
- **Payments & delivery:** Shopify with a local payment gateway, Tabby/Tamara for BNPL, a Dubai 3PL or courier for same-day delivery.
- **Labelling:** check UAE requirements for fibre content, origin and care labels on imported textiles.

Risk	Mitigation
Padel hype cools off	Court-to-table design keeps pieces wearable off court; GCC expansion spreads the bet.
Big brands copy the idea	Speed, local community and Night Sessions. Adidas can't run a Tuesday 11pm game in Al Quoz.
Cooling claims don't hold up in real heat	Wear-test every sample on courts in August; only print ratings you have tested.
Too much stock, wrong sizes	Small first runs, pre-orders for Partner Sets, restock only proven sellers.
Modest line feels like an afterthought	Co-design it with women who actually play; hire a female ambassador lead.
Cash tied up in inventory	B2B kits are paid upfront (50% deposit); consignment only with clubs that sell.
Name conflicts	Trademark search on LAYL and alternatives before spending on branding.

The first 90 days

Weeks	What to do	Done when
1–2	Visit 8–10 clubs at night. Talk to pro-shop staff, coaches and 30+ players. Photograph what people wear.	You know the top 3 complaints about current kit
2–3	Trademark search and file. Pick free-zone and apply for licence.	Name secured, licence in progress
3–6	Designer + tech packs for 12 pieces. Samples from 3 factories per category.	Samples in hand
6–8	Wear-test on real night courts with 20 players. Pick the winners.	Final spec for 6–8 launch pieces
6–10	Pitch Club Kit Studio to 10 clubs/academies and 5 companies.	First B2B order or deposit
8–10	Place first production. Build site. Shoot night campaign.	Stock ordered, content ready
10–12	Open Partner Set pre-orders. Sign 10 coach ambassadors. Book first Night Session.	100+ pre-orders = green light

Decisions for you

- **Name:** LAYL, SHAMAL, or something else?
- **Budget:** lean (~AED 110k, prove it first) or full (~AED 250k, launch big)?
- **Lead customer:** mixed from day one, or lead with the modest women's line as the sharpest niche?
- **B2B:** run Club Kit Studio under the LAYL name, or as a separate white-label business?
- **Your role:** founder-operator full time, or partner with a designer and a padel coach as co-founders?

The one-line pitch: LAYL is the padel brand for how the Gulf actually plays: at night, in the heat, in pairs. Built for 45°C, designed for after dark.